

MORE FROM FORBES

Aug 10, 2026, 08:23am EDT

**Political Identity Now Drives
Billions In Consumer Funding**

Aug 09, 2026, 05:27pm EDT

**Coding Jobs Vanish For Juniors
As AI Reshapes Career Path**

Aug 07, 2026, 02:37pm EDT

**The Four AI Narratives
Venture Capital**

→

ADVERTISEMENT

EDITORS' PICK INNOVATION > VENTURE CAPITAL

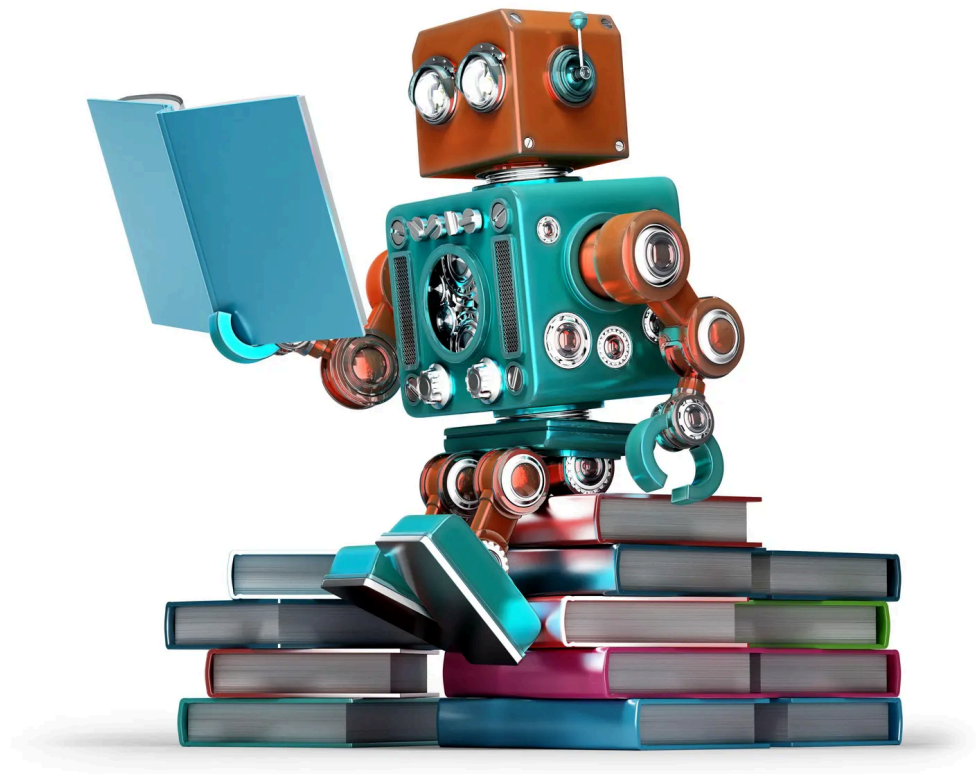
Machine Learning In The Enterprise: Where Will The Next Trillion Dollars Of Value Accrue?

By Louisa Xu, Former Contributor.

Published Jul 15, 2020, 11:30am EDT, Updated Jul 16, 2020, 02:54pm EDT



This article is more than 6 years old.



Every company will become an ML company.
GETTY IMAGES

In the world of Harry Potter, the sorting hat serves as an algorithm that takes data from a student's behavioral history, preferences and personality and turns that into a decision on which Hogwarts house they should join. If the real world had sorting hats, it would take the form of machine learning (ML) applications that make autonomous decisions based on complex datasets. While software has been "eating the world," ML is starting to eat software, and it is supercharging trillion-dollar global industries such as healthcare, security and agriculture.

If ML is expected to create significant value, the question becomes: where will this value accrue? I will explore ways that value will be created and captured by three types of companies: traditional companies applying ML, companies building industry-agnostic ML tools and companies building vertically-integrated ML applications.

Machine learning is not just for the tech giants

Subscribe to Continue Reading

Become a member and unlock unlimited digital access, expert analysis and exclusive member benefits.

Already a member? [Sign In](#)

Monthly

Digital Membership

\$12.99

Billed Monthly

Subscribe

Annual

LESS THAN \$2/WEEK

Digital Membership

\$89

Billed Annually

Subscribe

Two Year

Digital Membership

\$165

Billed Biennially

Subscribe

Subscriptions renew automatically. You may cancel your subscription at any time.

- Premium access to exclusive events, thought-provoking conversations with global leaders and more, all available on-demand.
- Elevated browsing experience with fewer ads and unlimited article saving power an enhanced reading experience.

[Back to the Home page](#) →

[Editorial Standards](#)

[Reprints & Permissions](#)



Find [Louisa Xu](#) on [LinkedIn](#).

RELATED TOPICS

SEE ALSO



© 2026 Forbes Media LLC. All Rights Reserved.

-
- [AdChoices](#)[Privacy Statement](#)[!\[\]\(cdf2842d82858164c68c92720a337fb9_img.jpg\) Your Privacy Choices](#)[Cookie Preferences](#)[Digital Terms of Sale](#)[Terms of Service](#)
- [Contact Us](#)[Send Us Feedback](#)[Report a Security Issue](#)[Jobs At Forbes](#)[Reprints & Permissions](#)[Forbes Press Room](#)

[Advertise](#)